Neal T. Gillespie

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Hiring Committee
Irving Public Library
City of Irving
825 W. Irving Blvd, Irving, TX 75060

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am applying for the Library Assistant position with the Irving Public Library. I have spent the last four years in nonprofit development, and the thread running through all of it has been organizing collections of material so other people can find what they need. I am now moving toward library work in earnest.

The posting asks for a year of related experience, so let me be specific about mine. In my current role I oversee a physical archive of printed materials, which means emptying bins of returns, sorting and routing items, shelving them correctly, and keeping the whole collection orderly enough that anyone can retrieve from it. When nobody could find anything in it, I built a searchable catalog so staff could pull materials themselves. Before that, as a student registrar at Chapman University's Fowler School of Law, I staffed the service window as the first person students talked to, registered and verified records, explained procedures, and processed over five hundred transcripts and exam records in PeopleSoft.

That combination is most of this job. Checking materials in, sorting and shelving them accurately, helping someone at a desk who is not sure what they need, and keeping records clean enough to trust are all things I have done daily, just not yet inside a public library. I am also comfortable with the physical side of the work and with the scheduling, including evenings and weekends.

I am working toward making this a career rather than a change of pace. I have begun the ALA's Library Support Staff Certification and will start a Library and Information Services certificate at Central Community College in the spring, and I expect to pursue a master's in library and information science after that. I also founded the Free Knowledge Library, an archive cataloging political literature, where I designed the classification scheme and built the catalog. That project is the clearest evidence I can offer that this interest is real and not recent.

Thank you for your consideration. I would welcome the chance to talk about the role.

Sincerely,

Neal T. Gillespie